Nevada Hamaker

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I started in technical support, transitioned to software testing, and then to a full-time software development role. My experience spans back-end and front-end testing and development, web services, databases, cloud infrastructure, and use of AI coding tools. My recent work has focused on ecommerce platform customization, migration of services and databases to Google Cloud Platform, and full-stack development using Java, PHP, React, TypeScript, GraphQL, and MySQL. I'm currently building Seura Photos, an open-source desktop photo app, using an AI-first workflow.

Technical Skills

Programming: PHP, Java, Spring Boot, JavaScript/TypeScript
Web & Cloud: React, Magento, GraphQL, Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Kafka
Databases: MySQL/MariaDB, Cloud SQL
DevOps: CI/CD, GitHub Actions, New Relic

Professional Experience

October 2025 - February 2026
Senior Software Engineer | *BFG Entertainment, Inc.*

Continued in the same role on the engineering team following the acquisition of the Big Fish Games downloadable games business by BFG Entertainment.

The major project I worked on was the complete rebuild of the Big Fish Games website front end on Adobe PWA Studio, replacing the previous front end built on Adobe Experience Manager. The new React-based site cut costs substantially, improved performance, and allowed faster iteration on fixes and features.

My accomplishments during this project include:

- Replaced or extended many of the existing React components and implemented several new ones. For example, I implemented a new "Promotional Content Block" component that is used by the Marketing team to display banners or other promotional material. It can choose from several different content blocks to display based on conditions including whether the customer has made any purchases and whether the customer is a member of Game Club.
- Implemented the payment methods page, including support for Game Club membership payments, which required updating a Magento GraphQL resolver.
- Adapted existing GraphQL queries, implemented new ones, and extended the Magento back end with new resolvers for product and customer data to support custom front-end functionality.

During this project, AI coding tools (Claude Code in particular) became truly useful. They accelerated customization, new feature implementation, GraphQL integration, and styling updates for the new front end. They allowed us to release it to production ahead of schedule and quickly follow up with updates and fixes. I continued to learn where my own judgment was still important and when to push back or change course.

Technologies used include: Adobe PWA Studio, Magento, React, GraphQL, PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, MySQL/MariaDB, Composer, Yarn, GitHub Actions, New Relic, Claude Code.

January 2022 - October 2025
Senior Software Engineer | *Big Fish Games, Inc.*

Promoted from Senior Software Design Engineer in Test to Senior Software Engineer after progressively taking on development responsibilities for the back-end web services that supported Big Fish's mobile and downloadable games businesses.

I worked on several projects, the largest of which was the modernization of the Big Fish Games ecommerce platform. We transitioned it from an on-premises stack developed in-house to a managed cloud-based architecture built on Adobe Magento and Adobe Experience Manager. This substantially reduced our footprint in the local data center, enabled faster and easier deployments, improved monitoring capabilities, and eliminated PCI-compliance responsibilities.

My accomplishments in this role include:

- Integrated and customized multiple Magento extensions to support Big Fish Games business needs.
- Integrated Magento with Klaviyo, including extending the Klaviyo extension for Magento and implementing additional custom code. This replaced Salesforce and allowed Big Fish to better manage email marketing campaigns.
- Adapted Magento and the existing authentication service to work together using SAML SSO, including custom logic for post-login redirects.
- Performed the first service migration to Google Kubernetes Engine and the first database migration to Cloud SQL, then documented the procedures I'd used. Other engineers followed those procedures to migrate additional services and databases, with my support.
- Designed and implemented a containerized Cloud Run service that gave the new Magento platform access to legacy purchase and customer data without migrating it, so millions of customers kept access to more than a decade of purchase history, including the games they had bought. The service also processed telemetry events and published them to Google Pub/Sub.
- Updated the DRM back-end service used for activation of games, making code and database changes to improve stability, fix longstanding issues, and enable tighter integration with Magento.
- Diagnosed a production failure in which reward points granted at migration all shared one expiration date, so the email system tried to send so many expiration notices at once that its cron job had to be disabled. I planned and carried out the fix, spreading the expirations out over time so notifications could resume.
- Contributed to development of the AEM front end, including implementation of the order history and game library pages.
- Contributed to the cross-platform Game Manager client application, a hybrid of C++/Objective-C++ and HTML/JavaScript/CSS. I fixed bugs, removed deprecated functionality, and updated authentication flows on both Mac and Windows.

Technologies used include: Magento, Adobe Experience Manager, PHP, Java, Spring Boot, JavaScript, TypeScript, Xcode, MySQL/MariaDB, Google Cloud Platform, Klaviyo, Terraform, Docker, Composer, npm, Maven, GitHub Actions, New Relic, Google Cloud Logging.

November 2010 - January 2022
Senior Software Design Engineer in Test | *Big Fish Games, Inc.*

I tested the Big Fish Games ecommerce website and later the web services behind the growing mobile games business, covering player communications, marketing and promotions, player segmentation, and a high-volume Kafka event pipeline feeding a large, sharded MySQL database.

My accomplishments in this role include:

- Architected, expanded, and maintained test automation framework and test case library for the Big Fish Games website, written in Python and built on Selenium, significantly improving test coverage.
- Expanded and maintained Java-based automation framework and test case library for the back-end services, significantly improving test coverage.
- Contributed directly to production web-service code and collaborated closely with developers. I progressively took on back-end development responsibilities that led to a formal transition to the Senior Software Engineer role.
- Designed and implemented a standalone microservice as part of a larger project, gaining hands-on experience with service design, integration, and deployment considerations.
- Implemented a utility written in C# which translated save game data for one of Big Fish's mobile games to and from its compressed binary format to support customer service's ability to update customers' save data as needed.
- Managed branch operations and CI/CD releases in a continuous delivery environment.

Technologies used include: Python, Java, Spring Boot, Dropwizard, JavaScript, PHP, Selenium, Jenkins, Docker, Kafka, Kubernetes, Google Cloud Platform, Redis, Memcache, Git, SVN, Mercurial, JIRA, Confluence, Kibana, and more.

Projects

Seura Photos - seuraphotos.app

A free, open-source photo organizer and editor for Windows and macOS, inspired by Picasa. Built AI-first: I make the product and design decisions and review the implementation, which Claude Code writes. A Tauri desktop app with a Rust core and a React and TypeScript interface, storing non-destructive edits in an open file format with its own specification, with cross-platform builds and tests in GitHub Actions. Public builds released October 2026, with development documented in a public devlog.

Bookmark Manager - github.com/nevadah/bookmark-manager

A cross-browser extension for Chromium-based browsers and Firefox (Manifest V3) that organizes bookmarks with hierarchical tags instead of folders, with optional AI auto-tagging through pluggable providers (Anthropic, OpenAI, Azure OpenAI, and OpenRouter). Built in TypeScript and React. I wrote the code myself, with Claude guiding the process, reviewing my work, and acting as a design collaborator; design decisions and how they changed after real use are documented in the repo. It stores data locally, in a JSON file or browser storage, and it's now my primary bookmark manager.

Additional Experience

August 2010 - September 2010
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Mantis Technology Group, Inc.*

- Created automation for testing a WCF Service for a client, delivering 120 automated test cases in 3.5 weeks and authoring project documentation.

September 2009 - August 2010
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Populus Group/Microsoft*

- Contract role on the Microsoft Mobile Services Platform team.

- Tested Microsoft Mobile Services Platform (MSP) SOAP services. Developed and maintained automation written in C#, and validated production systems.

February 2009 - July 2009
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Sage IT/Getty Images*

- Contract role at Getty Images on the Partner Portal team.
- Tested new digital asset storage and web services for Getty Images and validated Partner Portal features.

August 2007 - January 2009
Software Test Engineer/Software Design Engineer in Test | *Electronic Evidence Discovery, Inc.*

- Tested web and Windows applications, co-architected automated test framework in C#, and maintained build deployment systems.

August 2006 - August 2007
Software Design Engineer in Test | *Excell Data Corporation/Microsoft*

- Contract role at Microsoft on the SharedView team.
- Led migration to new UI test automation framework for SharedView. Expanded coverage of C# test automation and created technical documentation.

June 2000 - July 2006
Software Test Engineer/Software Design Engineer in Test | *Microsoft Corporation*

- Member of the Visio product team.
- Tested major Visio functionality including printing, database connectivity, the Database Modeling Diagram solution, and Shape Search.
- Implemented automated testing of online shape search feature.
- Drove Windows compatibility and Logo compliance.

1996 - June 2000
Software Test Engineer | *Asymetrix/Click2Learn*

- Member of the ToolBook product team.
- Tested multiple versions of ToolBook.
- Developed automation using OpenScript programming language.

Education

Bachelor of Science degree in Math/Computer Science, Western Washington University, 1993